

8.7 AI Gone Bloody Wrong

Duke Nukem 3D was a very popular FPS game back in around 1997. You had the single-player and multi-player options, and included in the multi-player option was the option to play with bots. They looked just like you, only they wore different colours.

It was almost impossible to defeat the bots, but that stemmed from the fact that they didn't have to figure out much to calculate their moves: the game was hardcoded into them! It was in God mode that we discovered the cracks — and a particularly gory one — in the AI.

Well, there's this weapon called the shrinker, that you use to shrink the other guy. You then stomp on him to kill him, and there's a little pool of blood. Now get into God mode, and all the bots get into God mode as well. And we discovered a scene where the bots showed the true colours of their intelligence.



Duking it out!

All you had to do was get two bots into a room, shrink one of them, and then step way back. The shrunken bot would shrink the other bot, and then the fun would begin. Immediately after shrinking the second bot, the first bot would stomp upon him, creating a pool of blood. But this is God mode, right? So the second bot wouldn't die. Then the second bot would get back his powers, shrink the first bot, and stomp upon him. More blood. And on and